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TOP STORY

Jay Jenkins resigns from Anniston council

By Bill Wilson, Star Staff Writer, wwilson@annistonstar.com

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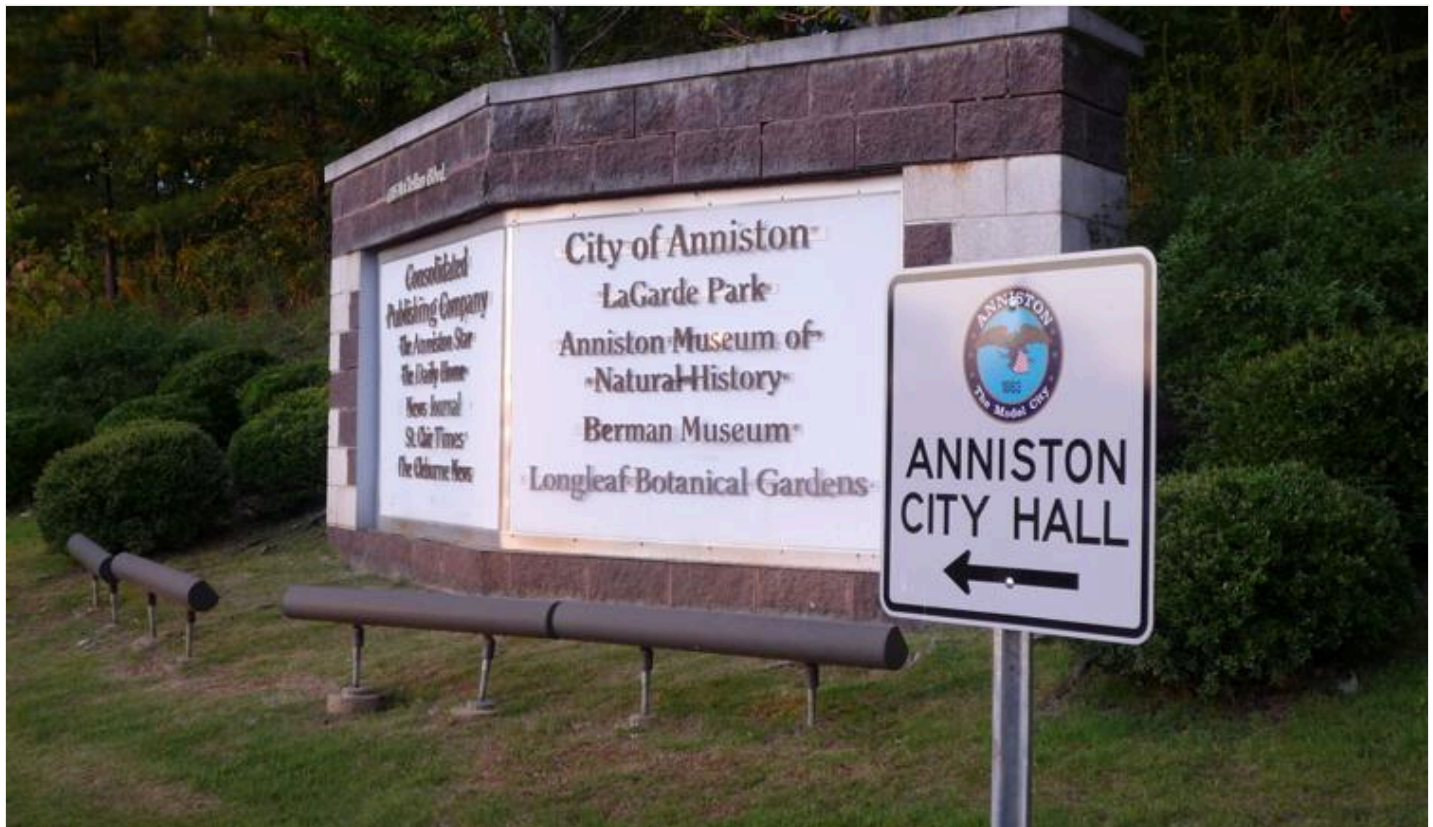
Anniston Ward 1 councilman Jay Jenkins stepped down Tuesday night after serving the city since 2010. Jenkins hugs councilman Demetric "DD" Roberts after the meeting. Photo by Bill Wilson, The Anniston Star

Anniston Ward 1 Councilman Jay Jenkins stepped down at the end of a somewhat routine City Council meeting Tuesday night. Jenkins' resignation was effective immediately.

During the council comments, which come at the end of the meeting, Jenkins said it was best for his well-being and business to resign.

"Over the past several months, it's becoming increasingly clear that a change in my life is in order so for my business and my health. I've come to the conclusion it's time for me to step down," Jenkins said. "I hereby submit my resignation as council member of Ward 1 of the city of Anniston, effective immediately. I wish our city good fortune in the years to come. Thank you."

Jenkins said he's been a public servant for the city since January 2010.



City announces qualifications for vacant council seat

“To Anniston city staff, both past and present, I thank you for listening to concerns and working towards solutions. You guys make elected officials look good to all members of all city councils. I thank you for open dialog, varied perspectives and immense effort in crafting and implementing a collective vision to move our city forward,” he said.

Jenkins said he loves Anniston and is beyond excited about the future of “our great city.” He said the city is moving in the right direction.

“I will continue to challenge our civic leaders to ask the tough questions and make the hard decisions required in the never ending pursuit of equality and economic growth,” Jenkins said.

The council was stunned at Jenkins’ announcement.

Mayor Jack Draper thanked Jenkins for his service to the city.

“We will certainly miss you. I will say that we're, I think we're all pretty surprised, but I certainly understand where you’re coming from,” the mayor said. “We wish you great future success.”

A replacement for Jenkin’s seat will be forthcoming and the council will look at the statute and the ordinance, Draper said.

“I think it's 30 days, so we will begin accepting applications quickly for the Ward 1 position ... the City Council will make that decision I think within a month,” the mayor said.

After the meeting, fellow council members hugged and thanked Jenkins for his service to the city. Jenkins declined to comment further on his decision.



Anniston Ward 1 councilman Jay Jenkins stepped down Tuesday night after serving the city since 2010. Jenkins (right) is being hugged by councilwoman Millie Harris. Councilwoman Ciara Smith in the background. Photo by Bill Wilson, The Anniston Star

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